

Associate professor

Born: 17/08/1994

French (native speaker), English, Italian
(fluent)

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Areas of expertise. Optimization, Machine learning, Control theory.

Specialist knowledge. Kernel methods, Functional analysis, Optimal control, State constraints, Infinite-dimensional convex optimization.

Positions and Education

Dec 2024 -	Researcher/Associate professor , CERMICS, ENPC, Marne-la-Vallée
Sept 2023 - Nov 2024	Post-doctoral researcher , TU Wien, VADOR, Vienna Optimization beyond metric spaces with A. Daniilidis
Sept 2021 - Aug 2023	Post-doctoral researcher , INRIA SIERRA, Paris Kernel methods for constrained optimization problems with A. Rudi
Sept 2018 - Aug 2021	PhD in Applied Mathematics , with N. Petit, MINES ParisTech, Paris Estimation and Control under Constraints through Kernel Methods
Sept 2017 - Aug 2018	Master of Public Policy , AgroParisTech and ENPC, Paris Banking and macroeconomics, Law, Environmental dialogue Report on AI for the scientific and technical agencies of the Ministry of Environment
2016 - 2017	Master of Science (M2) , MVA (Mathematics-Vision-Learning), ENS Paris-Saclay, Cachan, Machine Learning and Big Data - Highest honors Specialized in convex optimization and kernel methods
Mars 2017- Aug. 2017	MS internship , with J-P. Vert, CBIO, Ecole des Mines Gene regulation inference from single-cell RNA sequencing
2013 - 2016	Master of Science/Engineering diploma, Cycle ingénieur polytechnicien , École polytechnique, Palaiseau Major: Applied Mathematics Minor: Quantum Physics and (Neuro)biology
2011 - 2013	Bachelor of Science , Lycée Louis-le-Grand, Paris <i>Classe préparatoire MPI</i> Mathematics, Physics, Computer sciences

Journal articles

All the documents (video, pdf and slides) are available at <https://pcaubin.github.io/>.

- [1] (Under review) PCAF, Virginie Ehrlacher, Gabriele Todeschi, *Debiasing optimal transport: classical and entropic*, 2026
- [2] (Under review) PCAF, Yohann De Castro, Axel Parmentier, Alessandro Rudi, *Generalization Bounds of Surrogate Policies for Combinatorial Optimization Problems*, 2024
- [3] (Under review) PCAF and Alain Bensoussan, *Reproducing kernel approach to linear quadratic mean field control problems*, 2023
- [4] (Under review) Flavien Léger and PCAF, *Gradient descent with a general cost*, 2023
- [5] Journal of Functional Analysis PCAF, Giacomo Enrico Sodini, Ulisse Stefanelli, *Evolution variational inequalities with general costs*, 2026
- [6] Communications in Contemporary Mathematics PCAF and Stéphane Gaubert, *Order isomorphisms of sup-stable function spaces: continuous, Lipschitz, c-convex, and beyond*, 2025

- [7] Pure and Applied Functional Analysis PCAF and Alain Bensoussan, *The reproducing kernel Hilbert spaces underlying linear SDE Estimation, Kalman filtering and their relation to optimal control*, 2024
- [8] Optimization PCAF and Alessandro Rudi, *Approximation of optimization problems with constraints through kernel Sum-Of-Squares*, 2024
- [9] International Game Theory Review Aubin, Jean-Pierre, PCAF and Vladimir Lozève, *Reintroducing Time, Money and Constraints: Viability to bridge the economic and monetary theories*, 2024
- [10] Integral Equations and Operator Theory PCAF and Stéphane Gaubert, *Tropical reproducing kernels and optimization*, 2024
- [11] Communications in Optimization Theory PCAF, Alain Bensoussan and Joe Qin, *Alternating minimization for simultaneous estimation of a latent variable and identification of a linear continuous-time dynamic system*, 2023
- [12] JMLR PCAF and Zoltán Szabó, *Handling Hard Affine Shape Constraints in RKHSs*, 2022
- [13] SIAM J. on Control and Optimization PCAF, *Linearly-constrained Linear Quadratic Regulator from the viewpoint of kernel methods*, 59(4) 2693–2716 2021
- [14] Comptes Rendus. Mathématique PCAF, *Interpreting the dual Riccati equation through the LQ reproducing kernel*, 359(2) 199–204, 2021
- [15] Bioinformatics PCAF and Jean-Philippe Vert, *Gene regulation inference from single-cell RNA-seq data with linear differential equations and velocity inference*, 36(18), 4774–4780, 2020
- [16] Systems & Control Letters PCAF, *Lipschitz regularity of the minimum time function of differential inclusions with state constraints*, 139 104677, 2020

Conference proceedings

- [1] IEEE CDC 2025 PCAF and Alain Bensoussan, *Solving LQ stochastic control and defining the controllability Gramian through kernel methods*, 2025
- [2] NeurIPS 2024 (spotlight) Clément Bonet, Théo Uscidda, Adam David, PCAF, Anna Korba, *Mirror and Preconditioned Gradient Descent in Wasserstein Space*, 2024
- [3] IEEE CDC 2024 PCAF and Alain Bensoussan, *Reproducing Kernel Approach to Linear-Quadratic Mean Field Control Problems with Additive Noise*, 2024
- [4] NeurIPS 2022 PCAF, Anna Korba, Flavien Léger, *Mirror Descent with Relative Smoothness in Measure Spaces, with application to Sinkhorn and EM*, May 2022
- [5] IEEE CDC 2022 PCAF and Alain Bensoussan, *Operator-valued Kernels and Control of Infinite dimensional Dynamic Systems*, 2022
- [6] IFAC CAO 2022 PCAF, *Stability of solutions for controlled nonlinear systems under perturbation of state constraints*, 2022
- [7] ICML 2021 (long oral) Anna Korba, PCAF, Szymon Majewski and Pierre Ablin, *Kernel Stein Discrepancy Descent*, 139 5719–5730, 2021
- [8] NeurIPS 2020 PCAF and Zoltán Szabó, *Hard Shape-Constrained Kernel Machines*, 33 384–395, 2020

- [9] IFAC WC 2020 PCAF, Nicolas Petit and Zoltán Szabó, *Kernel Regression for Trajectory Reconstruction of Vehicles under Speed and Inter-Vehicular Distance Constraints*, 53(2) 15084–15089, 2020
- [10] ECC 2020 PCAF and Nicolas Petit, *Data-driven approximation of differential inclusions and application to detection of transportation modes*, 1358-1364, 2020

Funding and Awards

- 2026: Hi! PARIS Internal Chair Fellowship Program (200k€ for DiffusOR - Diffusion models for Operations Research)
- 2026: Programme France 2030 Sci-Ty (50k€ for EnergyMapperOptim - Optimization module for energy mix)
- 2025: co-chair of the AIr-France ENPC Industrial Chair (1,3M€/5y)

I received the Prix Dodu at SMAI-MODE 2024, and the best post-doc presentation at Lifting Inference with Kernel Embeddings 2022. I got a 5k€ prize as team leader of the best project at hackaton #DataEnergie 2017.

Teaching experience

- 2026-: Teaching assistant in convex optimization for graduate studies at ENPC
- 2025-: Lecturer of the “Decision in Uncertainty” course for advanced undergraduate studies at ENPC (Markov chains, Bellman equations)
- 2019-2021: Teaching assistant in optimization for advanced undergraduate studies at Mines Paris – PSL
- 2013-2014: Full-time science teacher (maths/physics) in senior high school in the underprivileged outskirts of Paris with Association Tremplin as part of the mandatory civic service of Ecole polytechnique

Other: Students, Reviewer duties, Invited talks

I have supervised three Master of Science interns: Adrien Chkirate (ENSAE), El Mahdi Khribch (Mines ParisTech), Yuxi Xie (ENSTA).

I was the external examiner for the PhD defence of Razvan-Andrei Lascu (Edinburgh). I served as a referee for OJMO, SIMA, IEEE CSM, JOTA, SIMODS, SIREV, Bernoulli, JMLR, AMOP, JCOMP, TAC (journals) ICML, AISTATS, NeurIPS, ECC, ACC and CDC (conferences). I have been invited at over 20 national and international conferences, such as MeRiOT 2024 in Varenna, One World Optimization Seminar at ESI Wien 2024, the Viennese Conference on Optimal Control and Dynamic Games (ORCOS-VC22), the European Conference on Operational Research (EURO-ESPOO), the French-German-Portuguese conference on optimization (FGP22), SIAM Conference on Control and Its Applications (CT21), and more.